SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #76 · DEATH & GRIEF

“If I grieve deeply, I don’t trust God.”

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Where it often comes from

Hearing “They’re in a better place, so don’t be sad.” A church culture that expects quick recovery from loss. Feeling pressure to look strong for others. Confusing hope with the absence of sadness. Guilt when tears keep coming months or years later.

What Scripture teaches

Grief is the price of love, and Scripture does not forbid it. Jesus knew He was about to raise Lazarus, and still He wept. Paul did not tell believers not to grieve, but not to grieve like those without hope. Jesus said those who mourn are blessed, for they will be comforted. God is near to the brokenhearted and keeps track of every tear. Deep grief and deep trust can live in the same heart.

> *“Brothers, we do not want you to be uninformed about those who sleep in death, so that you will not grieve like the rest, who are without hope. For since we believe that Jesus died and rose again, we also believe that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in Him”*
> **(1 Thessalonians 4:13–14)**.

Also see

> “When Jesus saw her weeping, and the Jews who had come with her also weeping, He was deeply moved in spirit and troubled. ‘Where have you put him?’ He asked. ‘Come and see, Lord,’ they answered. Jesus wept” **(John 11:33–35)**.

> “Blessed are those who mourn, for they will be comforted” **(Matthew 5:4)**.

> “You have taken account of my wanderings. Put my tears in Your bottle— are they not in Your book?” **(Psalm 56:8)**.

> “Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our troubles, so that we can comfort those in any trouble with the comfort we ourselves have received from God” **(2 Corinthians 1:3–4)**.

Common self-statements

- If I really trusted God, I wouldn’t be this sad.
- I should be over this by now.
- My tears show weak faith.
- I have to be strong for everyone.
- Christians shouldn’t grieve this much.
- I’m letting God down by hurting so badly.

Common logical errors

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you must either trust God or grieve, but not both.
- **Should statements:** “I should be over this by now.”
- **Comparison:** Measuring your grief against how others seem to cope.
- **Misreading Scripture:** Hearing “do not grieve like the rest” as “do not grieve at all.”

Challenging questions

- Did Jesus weep, even knowing He would raise Lazarus?
- What did Paul actually say about grief in 1 Thessalonians 4:13?
- What does Jesus promise to those who mourn?
- Does God keep track of my tears or scold me for them?
- Can I grieve and hope at the same time?
- Who told me grief means weak faith?
- What kind of comfort do I need right now?

Truth summary

> Grieving deeply does not mean I don't trust God. Jesus wept, and God keeps track of my tears. I can grieve with hope, trusting that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in Him. Blessed are those who mourn, for they will be comforted.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Grief
- Sorrow
- Death/Dying
- Trust
- Hopeless

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Grief
- Death and Dying

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I grieve deeply, I don't trust God"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I grieve deeply, I don't trust God." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Did Jesus weep, even knowing the outcome?
- ☐ What did Paul say about grief?
- ☐ What does Jesus promise those who mourn?
- ☐ Does God keep my tears or scold me?
- ☐ Can I grieve and hope together?
- ☐ What comfort do I need now?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Grief is the price of love, not a lack of faith.
- ☐ Jesus wept, and He understands.
- ☐ I can grieve with hope.
- ☐ God keeps track of my tears.
- ☐ Blessed are those who mourn, for they will be comforted.
- ☐ God comforts me in all my troubles.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Thessalonians 4:13–14**
  "Brothers, we do not want you to be uninformed about those who sleep in death, so that you will not grieve like the rest, who are without hope. For since we believe that Jesus died and rose again, we also believe that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in Him."

- [ ] **John 11:33–35**
  "When Jesus saw her weeping, and the Jews who had come with her also weeping, He was deeply moved in spirit and troubled. 'Where have you put him?' He asked. 'Come and see, Lord,' they answered. Jesus wept."

- [ ] **Matthew 5:4**
  "Blessed are those who mourn, for they will be comforted."

- [ ] **Psalm 56:8**
  "You have taken account of my wanderings. Put my tears in Your bottle— are they not in Your book?"

- [ ] **2 Corinthians 1:3–4**
  "Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our troubles, so that we can comfort those in any trouble with the comfort we ourselves have received from God."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Grief and comfort journal:** Each day, write one thing I miss and one way God or someone comforted me.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Matthew 5:4 becomes: "Blessed is **Sarah** as **she** mourns, for **she** will be comforted."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Grief" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Give yourself a set time to grieve each day,** looking at pictures or writing, and then do one comforting activity.
- ☐ **Read John 11:17–44 slowly,** and notice how Jesus responds to Mary's tears.
- ☐ **Join a grief support group** or talk with a grief counselor or pastor.
- ☐ **Let one friend know** that you are still grieving and what would help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I grieve deeply, I don't trust God": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One comfort I received
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I grieve deeply, I don't trust God.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, thank You that You wept at Your friend's grave. Help me reject the lie that deep grief means I don't trust God. Keep my tears in Your bottle, comfort me in my sorrow, and let me grieve with hope. In Your name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.